REDESIGN 2003 A READER'S GUIDE

What we did, and why

We constantly conduct research into readers' interests and needs, and we watch for trends. It became clear that our readers wanted expanded local content and an updated look. With this redesign, we offer three things: more local, regional and state news every day; three new sections to serve special reader interests; and a contemporary new look.

OUR NEW LOOK





BEFORE REDESIGN

1 Our new look: all about ease

Changes made to the typography and layout of The News-Press were all designed to make it easier for readers to use the newspaper. The type that we use for stories is now larger. Colors have been assigned to each section as visual markers for readers. And labels and dividing lines are being used to more clearly distinguish stories and topics.

FINDING YOUR WAY AROUND

We formerly used a left-hand column on page A1 to tell readers where to find information inside the newspaper. The narrow, static space confined our ability to showcase features that readers might enjoy – if only they knew about them. We've moved those items to a horizontal space to provide a better road map to the day's newspaper.

TYPOGRAPHY

About 80 percent of the material on a newspaper page is text. Readers are drawn first to the photographs and graphics, but spend much more time with words. We've selected new type for our words, both stories and headlines.

- HEADLINES
  For those of you who know design or just like lots of detail, here's what we chose for headline fonts: The primary news headlines will be Miller Headline, a serif type that is authoritative and highly readable. Relay, a sans-serif type, is crisp and contemporary. It will be used most often for feature stories.
- TEXT TYPE
  The type used for stories is now slightly larger. More noticeable is that it is bolder. We've also increased the white space between lines of type because that makes reading much easier.
- TOPIC LABELS
  We will use labels to call attention to topics that are of especially high interest to our readers – topics such as education, environment and growth/development. Labeling allows us to give more specific information in the headlines themselves.

KNOWING WHERE YOU ARE

We've adopted a new way of labeling pages in every section to make it easier for busy readers to quickly spot what they're seeking. "Nation and World," for example, gets to the point better than the previous name, "Spotlight."



FINDING YOUR WAY WITH COLOR

Each section of The News-Press has been assigned a color. Sports, for example, is sand (we chose a color palette to reflect Southwest Florida). If a graphic or promotional item from Sports appears in another section, it will remain sand-colored as a visual clue for the reader.

- NEWS
- SPORTS
- BUSINESS & MONEY
- LIFESTYLES
- HEALTHY LIVING



MORE ONLINE

Log on for more details about the redesign and content changes. Hear from design editor Jeremy Gilbert on the strategy behind the new look.
n news-press.com

New sections 2

Three new sections have been created to allow deeper coverage of high-interest topics, and they are a disparate bunch.
One targets a geographic area that is growing explosively: Cape Coral.
One targets a lifestyle: active Floridians who want to feel good and look good.
And one targets almost everyone: Those of use who are always thinking about buying, selling or fixing up a home.

THE CAPE

Cape Coral's population of 124,000 is projected to hit 155,179 by 2010 and 473,617 when fully developed by 2080. Two years ago, we added a section to Sunday's newspaper for Cape readers called "The Cape." It's time to expand that. To keep pace with the growth, we're adding "The Cape" to Cape Coral editions on Tuesdays and Thursdays.

- We will continue to cover Cape Coral news on page A1 and the Local & State section, focusing on issue-based stories and breaking news.
- These new sections will allow us to expand our coverage of business, recreation, neighborhoods, churches and people.

HEALTHY LIVING

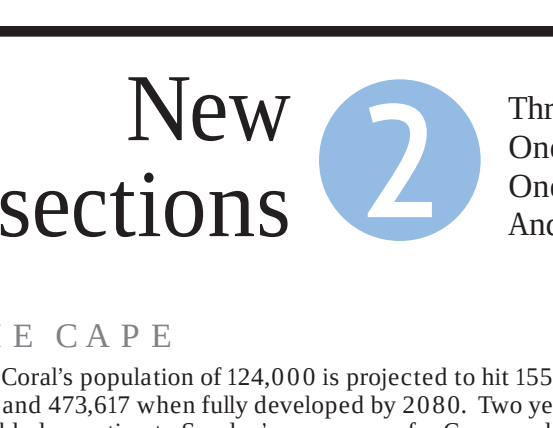
When we survey readers' interests there is always very high interest in health care, fitness, diet and nutrition. Readers here are especially interested in how living in Southwest Florida affects their lives. This new section is being added on Tuesdays and will include:

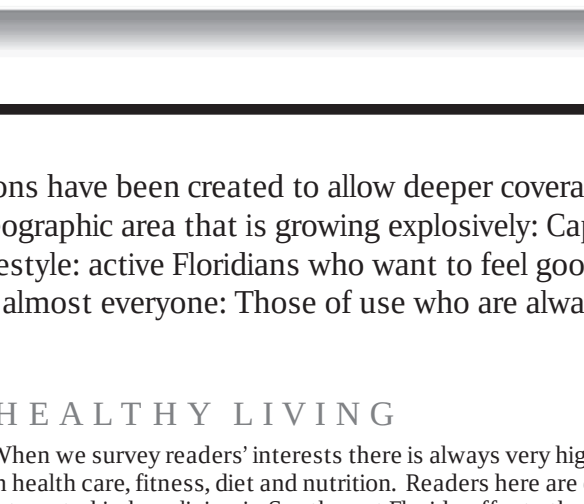
- Fitness features
- Beauty/ appearance tips
- Advice specific to subtropical life

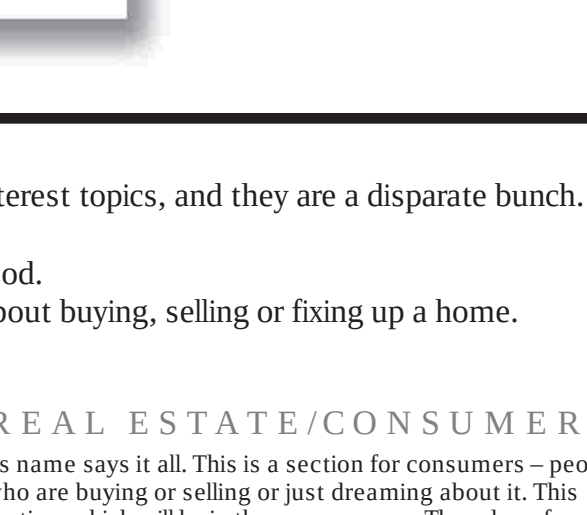
REAL ESTATE/CONSUMER

Its name says it all. This is a section for consumers – people who are buying or selling or just dreaming about it. This section, which will be in the newspaper on Thursdays, focuses on useful information such as:

- Advice for renters
- Columns on how to buy and sell
- Tips specific to Southwest Florida







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3 New local pages

Our readers turn to us for local news more than anything else. But what is "local" news? News of your neighborhood, or your town, your region or your state? Readers want news about all of those things. We've expanded the space in the Local & State section and divided it so that each kind of "local" news is covered more and is easier to find.

YOUR COMMUNITY

Seven days a week this page will deliver news of churches, clubs, neighborhoods and schools. To produce this, we've created a "community team" of journalists. They will need the help of clubs, organizations and schools. Phone, fax and e-mail information will be published on this page every day. Please send us your community news.

Each page will have a calendar of community events that day and the following day. Other items will appear on specific days:

- SUNDAY Neighborhood news • Volunteer opportunities Roadwatch • Pet of the week • Reunions
- MONDAY Calendar of public meetings, hearings Crime log: Fort Myers, south Fort Myers, Estero
- TUESDAY School news • School calendars District calendar • PTO, SAC calendar
- WEDNESDAY Bragging rights (awards and accomplishments) Club news • Crime log: Sanibel, Captiva, Fort Myers Beach
- THURSDAY Veterans calendar • Military reunions • Military notes Crime log: East Fort Myers, Tice, east Lee County
- FRIDAY Community calendar • Driving classes • Support groups Crime log: Lehigh Acres, North Fort Myers
- SATURDAY Religion briefs • Faith calendar

SOUTHWEST FLORIDA

This daily page pulls together information from around our region – Fort Myers, Bonita, Cape Coral, Lehigh Acres and, at times, Collier, Charlotte, Hendry and Glades counties. In the past, those stories could be a bit scattered, appearing in several places. For the convenience of our readers, we're organizing it more logically.

This page is designed to broaden our coverage throughout the area. It will be anchored with a roundup of briefs and include both features and news stories.

FLORIDA

This page spans all of Florida, from the Panhandle to the Keys. Our news bureau in Tallahassee will keep a watch on state government. We'll also present the most significant or most interesting stories of the day from our wire services. This page will be anchored by a collection of briefs.



4 Old favorites get new looks, new content

Even the most enduring sections of The News-Press need to be updated occasionally. Changes to these longtime favorites are designed to reflect our evolving community and today's busy lifestyles.

OPINION

- Three new columnists – Jabari Asim, Fareed Zakaria and Jonathan Alter — are being added to the rotation to give greater diversity of perspective.
- "Casual Friday" will, as the name suggests, be a more irreverent look at the week's issues each Friday. It supplements the regular editorial page.

NATION & WORLD

- Some stories "jump" to inside pages because there's too much information to fit on the front page. Readers don't like to have to search for the continuation, so we are anchoring "jumps" on the first two inside pages of the A section.
- "Coming this week" on page A2 will highlight a special feature or project coming later in the week.

BUSINESS & MONEY

- This section's new name (we've added "and Money") reflects more focus on personal finance and consumer information.
- Greater emphasis will be put on news about local businesses.
- "Newsmakers," which currently runs only on Mondays, will appear every day.



GULF COASTING

- Our entertainment guide has been organized by topic so information is easier to find.
- Many topics have been changed to at-a-glance grid formats.
- Added: events around the state.
- Added: roundup of events for kids.
- Expanded: "best bets" for weekend fun

LIFESTYLES

- "Community Buzz" column on Mondays shares extraordinary achievements by ordinary people.
- New: Columns by staff writers Miriam Pereira (exploring cultural diversity) and Drew Sterwald (examining culture and community).
- New: Shortcuts, a page of household hints and consumer tips for busy people.
- New: "Chef's secret" each Wednesday offers tips from chefs at local restaurants.
- New: Family ties, a page about parenting, grandparenting and family relations.
- New: The "it" list of trendy things to do – watch it, hear it, drink it, etc., each Friday.



119 years of change

1884
Editor Stafford C. Cleveland lands by happenstance in Fort Myers and starts the young city's first newspaper, The Fort Myers Press. Essays, poetry and advertising solicitation spread over the front and back of the single sheet.

1898
Once fierce competitors, the Fort Myers Press and the Tropical News have merged. The front page is now packed with news, society, community announcements, opinions and advertising adorned with illustrations.

1904
The newspaper's flag proclaims "No stormy Winter Enters Here, 'Tis Joyous Spring throughout the year," and the front-page news reflects the beginnings of the tourism and real estate economies.

1918
A free Extra edition boldly marks the end of the war with huge headlines. And the paper maintains its sense of community by quoting its famous winter resident Thomas A. Edison: "There is only one Fort Myers and ninety million people are going to find it out."

1927
"Plucky young" Charles Lindbergh's cross-Atlantic flight gets top billing, with the news stripped across eight columns of international, national, state and Lee County reports.

1931
Beneath Edison's portrait, the caption reads: "The little path that leads from Seminole Lodge across McGregor Boulevard to the little green laboratory where Thomas A. Edison had been engaged in momentous experiments will know the footsteps of the world famous inventor no more." The newspaper's name has evolved to the Fort Myers News-Press

1945
The front page is devoted to the end of World War II.

1960
Spot news photography packaged with stories and bold headlines document the destruction wrought by Hurricane Donna.

1963
Now-famous photographs and layers of headlines tell the shocking news of the assassination of President John F. Kennedy, Lee Harvey Oswald's arrest and Lyndon B. Johnson's swearing in.

1969
While the front page tells the historic story of Edwin Aldrin and Neil Armstrong on the moon, below the fold, the newspaper teases to other news inside: "Senator Kennedy to be charged with leaving accident scene. Page 3A."

1974
Above its nameplate, the newspaper promotes "10 full pages" of coverage of President Richard Nixon's resignation.

1982
Local election news shares the spotlight with national headlines on this front page that includes "skyboxes" that guide readers to sports and features.

